

Unit-1

The Selfish Giant

- Oscar Wilde

• 'Personification

- The literary device in which human qualities are given to non-human things.

• Literary Device

- Figurative Device

- The Technique or element of literature that enhances the overall meaning of a literary.

① Symbolism

→ A literary device is characterized by a word or phrase indicating an indirect meaning.

e.g. ÷ Children symbolize love and Innocence.

÷ In story season symbolize rewards and punishment

÷ Tree symbolize true marker of little boy.

÷ Corner of garden symbolize paradise.

÷ Snow falls symbolize meaning or means of misery and Pain.

② Personification

→ The literary device that assign human qualities to non-human things.

• Answer the following questions.

a) Where did the children use to play?

Ans The children used to play in a large lovely garden with soft green grass. Over the grass there were beautiful flowers like stars and also there were twelve peach trees that gave beautiful flowers in the spring and reach fruits in the autumn. This garden was favourite not only to the children but also the birds. The birds and the trees also entertain the children's arrival. It was their favourite place to spend free time and play. Therefore the children went to the giant's garden every afternoon after school and played there.

b) What did the Snow and Frost do to the garden?

Ans The snow covered up the grass with her great white cloak and the frost painted all the trees silver. Not only that they also invited the north wind to stay with them and the north wind roared all day about the garden and blew the chimney pots down. Again they invited hail on a visit and the hail rattled on the roof of the castle till he broke most of the slates, he ran round and round the garden as fast as he could go.

c) What did the giant hear when he was lying awake in bed?

Ans The giant heard a lovely ~~musical~~ music when he was lying awake in bed early morning. Music was sounded so sweet to his ears that he thought it was the king's musicians passing by. It was really only a little linnet singing outside his window, but it was so long since he had heard a bird sing in his garden that it seemed to him to be the most beautiful music in the world. It was such a really beautiful music which make the hail stop dancing over his head, North wind ceased roaring, and delicious perfume came to him through casement.

d) Why do you think spring season never came to the giant's garden?

Ans I think spring season never came to the giant's garden because of his selfishness. The giant was very selfish. He didn't allow anyone to play in his garden except himself. He had built a high wall all round it and put up a notice board where ~~"For"~~ "Trespassers will be Prosecuted" was written which means he strictly disallowed the children to play in his garden. Due to the absence of children in the garden and because of giant's selfishness spring season never came to the giant's garden.

e) How did the giant realise his mistake?

Ans One morning when giant was lying awake in bed a sweet song sounded to his ears. He saw a bird was singing in his garden which is very sweet and most beautiful song or music in the world. The song changed his garden from worst to best garden because the children had entered in the giant's garden through a little hole. Trees, birds or whole garden was entertain due to the presence of children. At that time when he saw a little child standing at a corner of garden, was trying to climb the trees and trees also wanted ~~to~~ boy to climb in the trees which realised the giant his mistake.

A. Read the extracts given below and answer the questions that follow.

a) "How happy we were there!" they said to each other.

i) Where does 'there' refer to?

Ans 'There' refers to giant's garden.

ii) What does 'they' refer to?

Ans 'They' refers to the children.

iii) Why are they ~~saying~~ saying so?

Ans They are saying so because they are not

allowed to enter the garden and play inside it as before because the selfish giant has strictly disallow them to play in the garden.

b) "I have many beautiful flowers," he said; "but the children are the most beautiful flowers of all."

i) Who is the speaker?

Ans Giant is the speaker.

ii) Who is he speaking to?

Ans He is speaking to himself.

iii) Who are 'the children' that the speaker is referring to?

Ans The speaker is referring 'the children' to the children nearby village.

iv) Why is the speaker saying that 'the children are the most beautiful flower of all'?

Ans The speaker is saying that 'the children are the most beautiful flower of all' because he understand, children are so innocent and the children are beautiful than flowers of the garden.

c. When the little child smiled at the Giant, and said to him, "You let me play once in your garden, today you shall come with me to my garden, which is paradise," shortly afterwards, the happy giant dies, what is the coincidence of this event? Describe it in relation to this fairy tale.

Ans The coincidence of this event is matched with the reference of Jesus Christ, who was hanged to death by nailing in his palms and leg. Here, the boy was also seen with the nail prints on his palm and his legs. The boy said, "Those were the wounds of love" in the same way, Jesus Christ also said, "Not to worry because I will come back for you again." Both the child and Jesus showed a deep love for the people and the giant.

B. The story makes use of personification as one of the main figures of speech. Cite three examples of personification from the story. What is the significance of the Seasons personified in the story.

→ The story 'The Selfish Giant' written by Oscar Wilde makes use of personification as one of the main figures of speech. Personification is a literary device that assigns human qualities to non human things. The seasons, The garden, The hail, snow,

etc are used as personification.

Winter, spring, and other seasons are depicted as having their own personalities and actions, reacting to the Giant's actions. For example winter refuses to leave the garden because the ~~selfish~~ Giant is selfish, and spring forgets the garden when the children are excluded. The garden itself is personified as being happy when children play there and sad when they are absent. Likewise The hail, The North Wind, ~~the~~ The Frost and The snow danced about through the trees because it was winter in the garden.

In conclusion, personification used in story - The seasons, The garden, The hail, The snow, The Frost, The wind make this story worth reading fairy tale. The personification of the season is crucial for illustrating the consequences of the Giant's selfishness and his subsequent journey towards redemption.

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c. This story can be read as a fairy tale, where the children, the seasons, the tree, the corner of the garden, the snow, the wind and the frost are all used as symbolism. Interpret those symbols.

Ans This story is a fairy tale that teaches a moral lesson to the readers by employing different symbol. basically Symbolism is a literary device that indicates an indirect meaning that enhances the meaning of a literary text. The children, The seasons, The tree, The corner of the garden, The snow, The wind, The Frost, The giant, The little child, and the giant's garden are used as symbolism.

The children symbolises love and innocent. It shows how innocent and adorable children can be to change someone's heart. The little child who kiss the selfish giant symbolises Jesus christ. Like wise the season symbolises rewards and punishment by the nature. Spring, Autumn and Summer symbolises rewards, vitality, abundance and happiness; whereas, winter symbolises struggle and difficulty. Similarly the tree symbolises true marker of the little boy's identity. Further more the corner of the garden symbolises paradise because it is the place

where god appears again and again. Also the snow, The wind and the Frost symbolises pain and misery. They also symbolises agent of nature to create hardship. Moreover the giants symbolises both good and bad aspects of human beings and the giant's garden symbolises the replica of eden's garden.

In conclusion the symbols -The children, The season, The tree, The corner of the garden, The snow, The wind, The frost and several other symbols make this story worth reading fairy tale.

D. Which figure of speech is used for 'winter, frost, snow, north wind, hail and little child? Who is the little child compared to?

Ans 'The Selfish Giant' by Oscar wilde ~~was~~ is a short story for children where figure of speech make this story worth reading fairy tale. Figure of speech mainly used in the story are Symbolism and personification. Symbolism is a literary device which is characterized by a word or phrase including an indirect meaning and Personification is a literary device that assign

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human qualities to non-human things. In the story winter, frost, snow, north wind, hail ~~and~~ etc are used as both symbolism and personification while little child is only used as a symbolism.

The little child is compared to Jesus Christ in the story. Jesus Christ was hanged to death by nailing ~~to~~ in his palms and legs. Here, the little boy was also seen ~~in~~ with the nails print on his palms and his leg. Jesus Christ was hanged because to spread love whereas the little boy also said, 'They were the symbol / wound of loves.' Both the Jesus and little boy showed a deep love for people and giant so the little boy is compared with Jesus.

a. What is the main theme of this story?
Ans A story 'The selfish giant' by Oscar Wilde is full of moral and lessons. The main theme of this story is the transformative power of kindness, generosity, and love, contrasted with the isolating and destructive nature of selfishness.

b. Does God Punish those who are cruel to children and are very selfish?
Ans Firstly God give a chance to transform

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their habit and action to those who are cruel to children and are very selfish. If they change God give forgive to them and took them to paradise after death otherwise they give punish to them. ~~and~~